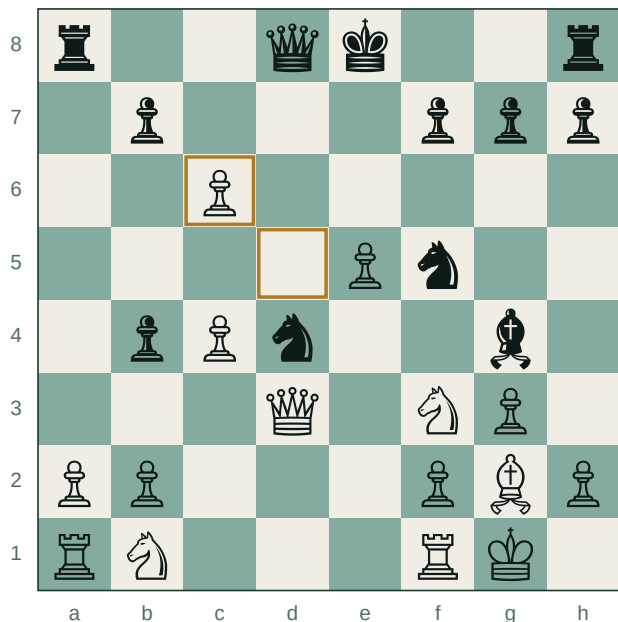


Kingside attacks: Black, move 14

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 14.dxc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14...Nxf3+ 15. Qxf3 Bxf3

14...Nxf3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on d8 attacks the queen on d3. Recorded reply: **15.Qxf3**.

15...Bxf3 The bishop captures the queen on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -3 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d3 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.